Paisa Samjho



Salary se Savings tak

A family money workbook in 20 chapters.



Paisa Samjho

Salary se Savings tak

by **Raj**



Paisa Samjho Raj

Financial education, advice nahi · Verma family is fictional

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Financial education, advice nahi. This book teaches money habits with examples. It is not financial, tax or legal advice. The author is not a SEBI-registered investment adviser. Decide for your own situation, or ask a registered adviser.

The Verma family is fictional. All their numbers are illustrative. No projection in this book is a promise of returns.

Every rupee sum in this book was worked out and checked by the build. Every rate, tax or RBI/SEBI rule is listed with its source and the date it was checked in "Sources and checks" at the back.

First edition, 2026 · paisasamjhoraj.com

How to use this book

1. Read one chapter a week with your family. Each chapter is 11 pages.
2. Every example uses the fictional Verma family from Lucknow (₹1,00,000 a month). Redo each sum with your own numbers.
3. Try the "What if...?" boxes: change one number and see what happens.
4. Fill the worksheet at the end of each chapter in pencil, then try the free calculator on paisasamjhoraj.com.
5. Do the practice page before peeking at the Answers at the back.

Meet Gullak Bhai, your money buddy. He fills up as your savings grow. Chhota-chhota daalo, bada-bada banao!

Hi! I'm Gullak Bhai. Let's talk paisa!



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CHAPTER 1 / 20

Where does the salary go?

> What you can see, you can save. Write down every spend for 30 days.

In this chapter

- ✓ Why money vanishes before the month ends
- ✓ The 30-day expense log
- ✓ The 3 jars: Essentials, Yearly + fun, Future
- ✓ Small leaks that become a big bill

Financial education, not advice.

Hi! I'm Gullak Bhai. Let's talk paisa!



The Verma family story



Meet the Vermas of Lucknow: Amit (35), Neha (33), Aarav (8) and Pihu (4). Together they take home ₹1,00,000 a month. On the 1st the salary arrives. By the 25th the account is almost empty, and nobody can say where it went. Rent and school fees are easy to remember. The office chai, the food delivery and the app subscriptions are not. So Neha starts a small notebook on the fridge. For 30 days, every spend goes in, even ₹10.

> **Remember:** What you can see, you can save. Write down every spend for 30 days.

Every family has a money story.



The idea

1. Most families keep the budget **in their head**. The head remembers big bills and forgets small ones.

2. For **30 days**, write every spend: date, what, how much. Phone notes or a diary both work.

3. At month end, put every line into one of **3 jars**: **Essentials** (rent, ration, school), **Yearly + fun**, and **Future**.

4. The three jars must add up to the **salary**. If they don't, some money has no name, and money with no name disappears.

> **Gullak Bhai's tip:** Log the spend the moment you pay. At night you will already have forgotten half of them.

Read slowly. It's easy, promise!



The rule up close

rule

```
Salary = Jar 1 Essentials
       + Jar 2 Yearly + fun
       + Jar 3 Future

Write it -> Sort it -> See it
```

`Jar 1` ➔ bills the house cannot run without

`Jar 2` ➔ yearly costs split monthly, plus planned fun

`Jar 3` ➔ money for later: emergency, retirement, kids' studies

`=` ➔ the jars must add up to the salary

One rule. Remember it!



Example 1

hisaab

Rent + maintenance	₹18,000
Groceries	₹14,000
Electricity, phone, net	₹4,000
Transport	₹6,000
School + activities	₹10,000
Insurance + health	₹6,000
= Jar 1 Essentials	₹58,000
Yearly costs (per month)	₹6,000
Fun	₹5,000
= Jar 2 Yearly + fun	₹11,000
Emergency fund	₹8,000
Retirement	₹13,000
Kids' studies	₹10,000
= Jar 3 Future	₹31,000
Total	**₹1,00,000**

Result

```
₹58,000 + ₹11,000 + ₹31,000 = ₹1,00,000
Matches the salary ✓
```

Illustrative · Verma family is fictional

Fifteen lines, three jars, one total. When the total equals the salary, every rupee has a job.

What if...? the total comes to less than the salary? Then some money has no jar. Find it in your 30-day log before you spend it.

Grab a pen and check the sums!



Step by step

Write 6 essentials	rent, ration, bills, transport, school, health
Add them	₹58,000: this is Jar 1
Yearly + fun	₹6,000 + ₹5,000 = ₹11,000 (Jar 2)
Future	₹8,000 + ₹13,000 + ₹10,000 = ₹31,000 (Jar 3)
Check	₹58,000 + ₹11,000 + ₹31,000 = ₹1,00,000 ✓

One step at a time. No rush!



Example 2: Small leaks

hisaab

Office chai + snack, ₹50 x 30 days	₹1,500
Food delivery, ₹200 x 8	₹1,600
3 app subscriptions, ₹99 each	₹297
= Leak per month	₹3,397
= Leak per year (x 12)	**₹40,764**

Result

```
Small spends: ₹3,397 a month = ₹40,764 a year
```

Illustrative · Verma family is fictional

No single spend here feels big. Together they cost the Vermas ₹40,764 a year, more than their Jar 2 for almost four months. That is why you write down even ₹10.

Same idea, new family!



Example 3: No jars: the 25th problem

hisaab

Salary on the 1st	₹1,00,000
Fixed bills paid by the 5th	₹38,000
Daily spends, ₹2,480 x 25 days	₹62,000
= Left on the 25th	**₹0**

Result

```
Left on the 25th: ₹0. Future jar: never filled.
```

Illustrative · Verma family is fictional

> Without jars, the future money looks like spending money, so it gets spent.

Example 4: With jars: future first

hisaab

Salary on the 1st	₹1,00,000
Jar 3 moved out on day 1	₹31,000
= Money for Jars 1 + 2	₹69,000
Jar 1 + Jar 2 plan	₹69,000
= Gap	**₹0**

Result

```
Saved before spending: ₹31,000 ✓ Gap: ₹0
```

Illustrative · Verma family is fictional

> Same salary, same bills. The only change: the future jar is filled first, on salary day.

Two more! Try your own numbers.



Real money mistakes

1. Tracking only the big bills

✗ What families do

hisaab

Salary	₹1,00,000
Big bills written	₹58,000
No name	**₹42,000**

₹42,000 a month has no name

✓ Better habit

hisaab

Salary	₹1,00,000
All 3 jars	₹1,00,000
No name	**₹0**

No name: ₹0 ✓

A plan that names only the big bills leaves ₹42,000 a month free to disappear.

2. Skipping small UPI spends

✗ What families do

hisaab

Money that left	₹1,00,000
Money in the log	₹96,603
Missing	**₹3,397**

Missing: ₹3,397 a month

✓ Better habit

hisaab

Money that left	₹1,00,000
Money in the log	₹1,00,000
Missing	**₹0**

Missing: ₹0 ✓

₹3,397 a month is the small-leak bill from Example 2. Log every UPI payment, even ₹10.

3. Saving what is left at month end

✗ What families do

hisaab

Left on the 25th	₹0
Saved	**₹0**

Saved this month: ₹0

✓ Better habit

hisaab

Moved on salary day	₹31,000
Saved	**₹31,000**

Saved this month: ₹31,000 ✓

Whatever is left at month end is usually nothing. Save first, then spend the rest.

Careful! Don't make these mistakes.



Practice time

1. Start your 30-day log today. Write the first three spends.
2. Your chai costs ₹30 a day. What is it per month, and per year?
3. List all your app subscriptions. Which one did you not open last month?
4. Sort last week's spends into the 3 jars.

★ **Challenge:** A family takes home ₹60,000. Jar 1 is ₹39,000 and Jar 2 is ₹9,000. How much can go into Jar 3 so the jars add up to the salary?

Cheat sheet

- Log every spend for 30 days, even ₹10
- 3 jars: Essentials · Yearly + fun · Future
- Jars must add up to the salary
- Small leaks x 12 = a big yearly bill
- Fill the Future jar first, on salary day

Next ➔ Chapter 2: is this spend a need, a want or just pressure?

Your turn! Answers at the back.



Your worksheet: 30-day expense log

Copy this page 3 times for 30 days. Write the jar number (1, 2 or 3) next to every spend.

#	Date	What	₹	Jar
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
Week total				

Try it free: Money Planner: put your 3 jars in and see the total. `paisasamjhoraj.com/#planner`

Small amounts, big savings!





BASIC

CHAPTER 2 / 20

Need, want or pressure?

> Wants are fine. Unplanned wants are the problem.

In this chapter

- ✓ Three questions for every spend
- ✓ Need vs want vs pressure
- ✓ The 24-hour rule for anything over ₹2,000
- ✓ Where pressure spending really comes from

Financial education, not advice.

Hi! I'm Gullak Bhai. Let's talk paisa!



The Verma family story



Neha's friend bought a new phone and posted it everywhere. Neha's own phone works perfectly. Still, the shop offers it on EMI: just ₹2,500 a month. That evening she opens her 30-day log and sees a costly wedding gift, a birthday party that grew bigger, and gadgets bought to keep up with friends. None of them were needs. None of them were planned. She asks one question: would the house run without this?

> **Remember:** Wants are fine. Unplanned wants are the problem.

Every family has a money story.



The idea

1. Ask every spend **three questions**. Can the house run without it? If not, it is a **need**.

2. It can, but you would enjoy it? That is a **want** (shauk). Wants are fine when the plan has room for them.

3. Only because of what people will say? That is **pressure** (dikhawa). Pressure never has a jar.

4. **24-hour rule**: any want over ₹2,000 waits one day. If you still want it tomorrow, buy it from Jar 2.

> **Gullak Bhai's tip:** Write the wish and the time in your phone. Set a reminder for the same time tomorrow. Most wishes feel smaller by then.

Read slowly. It's easy, promise!



The rule up close

rule

```
Need     -> the house stops without it
Want     -> nice, and there is room in Jar 2
Pressure -> only for what people say

Want > ₹2,000 ? wait 24 hours
```

`Need` ➔ goes in Jar 1

`Want` ➔ goes in Jar 2, inside its limit

`Pressure` ➔ no jar: say no, or turn it into a planned want

`24 h` ➔ the cooling-off time for big wants

One rule. Remember it!



Example 1

hisaab

Medicines	₹800
Aarav's school shoes	₹1,500
Gas cylinder	₹900
= Need	₹3,200
Weekend dinner out	₹2,400
Movie	₹1,200
New kurta	₹1,400
= Want	₹5,000
Costly wedding gift	₹5,000
Gadgets to match friends	₹2,500
Bigger birthday party	₹3,000
= Pressure	₹10,500
Total extra spends	₹18,700
Pressure share	**56.1%**

Result

```
Need ₹3,200 · Want ₹5,000 · Pressure ₹10,500
Pressure = 56.1% of ₹18,700
```

Illustrative · Verma family is fictional

Nine spends from Neha's log. The wants fit the ₹5,000 fun jar exactly. The pressure spends are more than half of all extra spending.

What if...? a need is costly, like a ₹20,000 fridge repair? It is still a need. Plan for it in Jar 2 (yearly costs), Chapter 4.

Grab a pen and check the sums!



Step by step

List the spends	take the extra spends from the 30-day log
Question 1	would the house stop? medicines, shoes, gas = need
Question 2	nice to have? dinner, movie, kurta = want
Question 3	only for people? gift, gadgets, party = pressure
Add each group	₹3,200 + ₹5,000 + ₹10,500 = ₹18,700

One step at a time. No rush!



Example 2: The 24-hour rule

hisaab

New phone	₹30,000
Smartwatch	₹4,000
Air fryer	₹6,000
Sale sneakers	₹3,500
= Wish list	₹43,500
Still wanted after 24 h: air fryer	₹6,000
= Not spent	**₹37,500**

Result

```
Wish list ₹43,500 -> bought ₹6,000 -> not spent ₹37,500
```

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Four wishes over ₹2,000. After one day only the air fryer still felt important, and Neha paid for it from Jar 2. The other ₹37,500 was never spent.

Same idea, new family!



Example 3: Wants with a plan

hisaab

Fun jar	₹5,000
Dinner + movie + kurta	₹5,000
= Left	**₹0**

Result

```
Wants fit the plan ✓ Left: ₹0
```

Illustrative · Verma family is fictional

> The Vermas did enjoy themselves. Because the wants had a jar, the fun cost nothing extra.

Example 4: Where pressure money comes from

hisaab

Future jar this month	₹31,000
Pressure spends (no jar)	₹10,500
= Future left	₹20,500
Future cut by	**33.9%**

Result

```
Future jar: ₹31,000 -> ₹20,500 (cut 33.9%)
```

Illustrative · Verma family is fictional

> Pressure has no jar, so it quietly eats the future jar: one third of this month's saving.

Two more! Try your own numbers.



Real money mistakes

1. Calling every EMI a need

✗ What families do

hisaab

Jar 1	₹58,000
+ Phone EMI as 'need'	₹2,500
= Jar 1 now	**₹60,500**

Essentials grow to ₹60,500

✓ Better habit

hisaab

Fun jar	₹5,000
- Phone EMI as a want	₹2,500
= Fun left	**₹2,500**

Honest: fun left ₹2,500

An EMI on a want is still a want. Put it where it belongs, then you can see the real trade-off.

2. Buying because it is on sale

✗ What families do

hisaab

MRP	₹5,000
Sale price (40% off)	₹3,000
'Saved'	**₹2,000**

'Saved' ₹2,000, spent ₹3,000

✓ Better habit

hisaab

Not needed, not bought	**₹0**

Spent ₹0, really saved ✓

A discount on something you did not need is not a saving. It is a ₹3,000 spend.

3. Gifts set by pressure

✗ What families do

hisaab

Gift per wedding	₹5,000
Weddings this season	4
= Gifts	**₹20,000**

Gifts: ₹20,000 with no jar

✓ Better habit

hisaab

Planned gift	₹2,000
Weddings this season	4
= Gifts from Jar 2	**₹8,000**

Gifts: ₹8,000, planned ✓

Decide the gift amount before the card arrives. The love is the same, the bill is ₹12,000 smaller.

Careful! Don't make these mistakes.



Practice time

1. Take 10 spends from your log. Mark each one N (need), W (want) or P (pressure).
2. Your wish list is ₹12,000. After 24 hours you still want ₹4,000 of it. How much did you not spend?
3. Name one EMI you pay. Is it a need or a want?
4. Write your gift amount for weddings this season, before any card arrives.

★ **Challenge:** Pressure spends cost a family ₹1,500 a week. How much is that in a year (52 weeks)?

Cheat sheet

- Need = the house stops without it
- Want = fine, inside Jar 2
- Pressure = no jar, say no
- Want over ₹2,000: wait 24 hours
- A sale is not a saving

Next ➔ Chapter 3: does the 50-30-20 rule fit your family?

Your turn! Answers at the back.



Your worksheet: 24-hour wish list

Write every want over ₹2,000 here first. Come back after 24 hours and tick only what you still want.

#	Wish	₹	Date + time	Still want?
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
Total not spent				

Try it free: Money Planner: give your wants a fixed jar.
`paisasamjhoraj.com/#planner`

Small amounts, big savings!





CHAPTER 3 / 20

Does 50-30-20 fit your family?

> Don't break the rule. Bend it to your family. Save first, then spend.

In this chapter

- ✓ What the 50–30–20 rule says
- ✓ Why it often does not fit an Indian family
- ✓ How to make your own split
- ✓ Splits for ₹30,000, ₹60,000 and ₹1,00,000 families

Financial education, not advice.

Hi! I'm Gullak Bhai. Let's talk paisa!



The Verma family story



Aarav comes home with a school project: 'Make a family budget with the 50-30-20 rule'. Amit finds the rule online: half for needs, 30% for wants, 20% for saving. They try it with the Vermas' ₹1,00,000. Needs get ₹50,000. But rent, ration, school and bills already cost ₹58,000. Aarav frowns: 'Papa, our house doesn't fit the rule.' Amit smiles: 'Then we make a rule that fits our house.'

> **Remember:** Don't break the rule. Bend it to your family. Save first, then spend.

Every family has a money story.



The idea

1. The **50-30-20** split was made popular by Elizabeth Warren and Amelia Warren Tyagi in the US book *All Your Worth* (2005): 50% needs, 30% wants, 20% savings, of take-home pay.

2. It is a **starting point**, not a law. Rent, school fees and family support can push Indian needs well above 50%.

3. Find **your** percentages: each jar ÷ salary × 100. The Vermas get 58 / 11 / 31.

4. The one rule that always fits: **save first**. Move the Future jar on salary day, then live on the rest.

> **Gullak Bhai's tip:** Lower income? Start with a small Future jar, even 10%, and raise it by 1% every time your salary goes up.

Read slowly. It's easy, promise!



The rule up close

rule

```
Jar % = jar ÷ salary × 100

50 / 30 / 20 = a starting point
Your family = your own split

Always: Future jar first
```

`50%` ➔ needs in the original rule

`30%` ➔ wants in the original rule

`20%` ➔ savings in the original rule

`÷ × 100` ➔ turns rupees into a percentage

One rule. Remember it!



Example 1

hisaab

Take-home salary	₹1,00,000
Needs (50%)	₹50,000
Wants (30%)	₹30,000
Savings (20%)	₹20,000
Total	₹1,00,000
Vermas' real needs	₹58,000
= Needs short by	**₹8,000**

Result

```
Rule: ₹50,000 / ₹30,000 / ₹20,000 = ₹1,00,000
Real needs are ₹8,000 more than 50%
```

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The textbook rule gives needs ₹50,000. The Vermas' needs are ₹58,000. On paper the rule works; in their house it is ₹8,000 short every month.

What if...? you live in a city with high rent? Needs can reach 60-65%. Then wants shrink first, not the Future jar.

Grab a pen and check the sums!



Step by step

Take the 3 jars	₹58,000 · ₹11,000 · ₹31,000 from Chapter 1
Jar 1 %	58,000 ÷ 1,00,000 × 100 = 58%
Jar 2 %	11,000 ÷ 1,00,000 × 100 = 11%
Jar 3 %	31,000 ÷ 1,00,000 × 100 = 31%
Check	58 + 11 + 31 = 100 ✓

One step at a time. No rush!



Example 2: The Vermas' own rule

hisaab

Take-home salary	₹1,00,000
Jar 1 Essentials	₹58,000
Jar 2 Yearly + fun	₹11,000
Jar 3 Future	₹31,000
Jar 1 %	58%
Jar 2 %	11%
Jar 3 %	31%
Total %	**100%**

Result

```
Verma split: 58% / 11% / 31% = 100%
```

Illustrative · Verma family is fictional

More for needs, much less for wants, and more for the future than the rule asks. It fits their life and still saves 31%.

Same idea, new family!



Example 3: A ₹30,000 family

hisaab

Take-home	₹30,000
Jar 1 Essentials	₹24,000
Jar 2 Yearly + fun	₹3,000
Jar 3 Future	₹3,000
Jar 1 %	80%
Jar 3 %	**10%**

Result

```
Split 80% / 10% / 10%: Future ₹3,000
```

Illustrative · Verma family is fictional

> Needs take 80%. A 10% Future jar is a real start; it grows with every raise.

Example 4: A ₹60,000 family

hisaab

Take-home	₹60,000
Jar 1 Essentials	₹39,000
Jar 2 Yearly + fun	₹9,000
Jar 3 Future	₹12,000
Jar 1 %	65%
Jar 2 %	15%
Jar 3 %	**20%**

Result

```
Split 65% / 15% / 20%: Future ₹12,000
```

Illustrative · Verma family is fictional

> Same 20% saving as the textbook rule, but with more for needs and less for wants.

Two more! Try your own numbers.



Real money mistakes

1. Forcing needs into 50% on paper

✗ What families do

hisaab

Needs on paper	₹50,000
Real bills	₹58,000
Future jar after the gap	**₹23,000**

Future quietly drops to ₹23,000

✓ Better habit

hisaab

Honest needs	₹58,000
Future jar	**₹31,000**

Future stays ₹31,000 ✓

A plan that hides ₹8,000 of real bills takes that ₹8,000 from the future every month.

2. Saving the 20% at month end

✗ What families do

hisaab

Planned saving	₹20,000
Actually left on the 30th	₹6,000
Missed	**₹14,000**

Saved ₹6,000, missed ₹14,000

✓ Better habit

hisaab

Auto-transfer on salary day	₹31,000
Missed	**₹0**

Saved ₹31,000 ✓

The percentage only works if the money moves first. Set a standing instruction for salary day.

3. Copying a richer family's split

✗ What families do

hisaab

Take-home	₹30,000
Needs	₹24,000
Copied 20% saving	₹6,000
= Left for yearly + fun	**₹0**

Yearly + fun: ₹0, the plan breaks

✓ Better habit

hisaab

Take-home	₹30,000
Needs	₹24,000
Start at 10%	₹3,000
= Left for yearly + fun	**₹3,000**

Yearly + fun: ₹3,000 ✓

A split with zero room for yearly costs breaks at the first festival. Start smaller and keep going.

Careful! Don't make these mistakes.



Practice time

1. Write your take-home salary and your 3 jars from Chapter 1.
2. Your salary is ₹45,000 and needs are ₹27,000. What percentage are needs?
3. Which jar would you cut first if rent went up by ₹3,000?
4. Set a reminder: move the Future jar on salary day.

★ **Challenge:** Make a split for ₹80,000 where the Future jar is 25% and essentials are ₹48,000. How much is left for Jar 2?

Cheat sheet

- 50 / 30 / 20 = a starting point, not a law
- Jar % = jar ÷ salary × 100
- Vermas: 58 / 11 / 31
- Cut wants before the Future jar
- Save first: auto-transfer on salary day

Next ➔ Chapter 4: Diwali doesn't come 'suddenly': yearly costs ÷ 12.

Your turn! Answers at the back.



Your worksheet: Your own split

Fill in rupees first, then work out each percentage. The three jars must add up to the salary.

Line	₹ a month	% of salary
Take-home salary		
Jar 1 Essentials		
Jar 2 Yearly + fun		
Jar 3 Future		
Total (= salary?)		
Future % goal next year		

Try it free: Money Planner: see your split as a chart.
`paisasamjhoraj.com/#planner`

Small amounts, big savings!



End of the free sample

You just read chapters 1 to 3. The full book Paisa Samjho: Salary se Savings tak has 20 chapters: the Verma family story, the rule, worked rupee examples, real money mistakes, practice with answers, a worksheet and a free calculator in every chapter.

Get the full book (PDF, 242 pages):
samjhowithraj.gumroad.com

English · Hinglish · Hindi editions

About the author

How do you get from a monthly salary to a ₹10 crore portfolio?



I'm Raj. I've worked in tech for 20 years, and I've been saving and investing for those same 20 years. Today I manage my own ₹10 crore portfolio. Every rupee I put into it came from my salary.

The number tells you where I am today. The question I find more interesting is one you can ask on payday: after the bills are paid and the groceries are bought, how much of this salary will still be mine a year from now?

I wrote Paisa Samjho so you could sit down with your own numbers and find your answer. If I could begin with a salary, you can begin with yours. When your next salary arrives, what would you like to keep?

Raj · Paisa Samjho Raj

Where does the salary go by the 25th?

Follow the Verma family through a month in Lucknow. Which bills come back every year? How much should they keep for emergencies? With three loans, which one goes first?

01 Worked rupee examples in every chapter

02 A worksheet for your own household

03 A free calculator to test your numbers

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